



PATH 01

Sell an AI playbook

You already know one job well enough to write it down. A stranger will pay to skip the guessing.

39 minute read · 8,653 words

Who this is for

Someone who can explain a single result — a week of content, a client intake, a job application pack — better than a blank chat window.

Time to first

7–21 days if you already know the job

Tools

First sale

A \$19–\$47 download bought by a person who is not you.

Cash window

\$19–\$47 first offer

Leave this alone

Google Docs or Word, Stripe Payment Link or Stan Store, one simple page, a second email to test-buy.

A 200-page 'everything AI' book, fifteen products, or waiting for a course platform.

What this actually is

Definition

A playbook is a job, written so a tired person can finish it without inventing the steps. The buyer is not shopping for inspiration. They are shopping for a sequence they can run this week. You already know one job well enough to write it down. A stranger will pay to skip the guessing.

The file is 8 to 15 chapters. Each chapter is a verb plus an object. Each chapter ends with one next action a tired person can do in 20 minutes. The first chapter is what done looks like. The last chapter is what they do next week. The middle is the work. A template or a paste-ready prompt lives in the file. Price the result, not the page count. A tight 18-page job at \$29 outsells an 80-page tour of your opinions.

What this is not

It is not a course, a community, or a 200-page everything-AI book. It is not a skill pack (that is the installable version). It is not a prompt stack (that is paste-as-you-go). It is the sequence, with prompts and templates inside it. It is not a service with a PDF attached. If you include a call, you just built Productized AI service. Keep the file at \$19 to \$47 and do not include your calendar. You are allowed to use AI to draft. You are not allowed to ship the draft. The money is in the rewrite: your examples, your order, your do-this-next at the end of every chapter.

Why this works now

Generic how-to-use-ChatGPT posts are free and infinite. The remaining gap is a named job for a named person with a named time box. Search is specific. People type 10 Google posts for a landscaper, not AI content system. Title-match is the distribution. Narrow is the moat. Models still stall. They still write a brochure when the buyer needed a caption. The playbook is the freeze of the sequence a careful person would run every time, if they had two extra hours,

which they do not. You do not need a following. You need one finished result you can explain in plain English.

Anti-pattern 1: the everything-AI book

A 200-page tour of tools and mindset is a hobby. Nobody runs chapter one on Tuesday. Cut it to one job. If you need and to name the result, you have two products. Split them. Sell the one you can finish this week.

Anti-pattern 2: shipping the draft

A pasted ChatGPT article with a cover is the fastest way to a refund. The buyer can get a draft for free. They cannot get your order, your examples, and a next action at the end of every chapter. If a chapter does not end with a next action, it is an essay. Cut it or finish it.

Anti-pattern 3: waiting for a course platform

A course platform is how people delay chapter one. You need Google Docs, a Payment Link, and ten messages. After a stranger has bought, you can put the same file on a nicer page. Not before.

The deal you keep

You keep three promises. One: a stranger can finish chapter one without you in the room. Two: every chapter ends with one next action, and the file has one real example plus one thing they can copy. Three: the checkout title matches the one-sentence offer, the price is on the page, and you have bought the file yourself from a second email. If chapter one does not survive a tired Sunday, the playbook is not a product.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

Fits if

This path fits if you have done a job more than three times and can name what went wrong the first time. That scar tissue is the product. People pay for the mistakes you already made.

You can explain a single result better than a blank chat window: a week of content, a client intake, a job application pack, a month-end close. You do not need a following. You need one finished result in plain English. You can send ten personal messages without a broadcast. You can take \$19 to \$47 without apologizing.

Skip if

Skip this path if you have never finished a result for anyone, including yourself. Write the playbook after you have a result, not as a way to avoid getting one. If you need cash this week, use a service path first (Productized AI service or Local businesses + AI), then turn the notes into this playbook. Skip if your title would be The AI Playbook with no job in it. Skip if you planned to write 80 pages of theory. Skip if you want a course platform before chapter one exists. Skip if you freeze at \$19 and want to start at \$297 with no proof.

The honest middle

If you have done the job twice and the third time is this week, capture that run as you do it. The playbook is the notes, cleaned. You are not waiting to become an expert. You are waiting to have a sequence you would hand a tired friend. You do not have to be the owner. The person who actually writes the posts or closes the month is enough if you can name what went wrong the first time.

Skills and time

Skills: name a job in one line. Outline 8 to 15 chapters as verb plus object. Rewrite a draft in kitchen-table English. Export a PDF. Make a Payment Link. Send ten messages.

Time if you already know the job: 7 to 21 days. Two evenings to outline. Four to draft. Two to rewrite and export. One evening for checkout, self-buy, and ten asks. If you only have 45 minutes a night, three chapters a night for four nights is the draft. Budget: \$0 if you already have Docs or Word and a way to take \$19.

Two-minute self-test

Answer these out loud. If you stall on two of them, this is not your first path this month.

What is the job in one line, in the buyer's words?

What does done look like as a file or a week of work, not a feeling?

What went wrong the first time you did this job?

Who is the specific person, plus one constraint?

Who are ten people you can message this week without a blast?

Can you finish an ugly draft in two weeks without research you have not done?

If you have the job, the done, the scar, and ten names, start tonight. If you only have I like AI, go finish a result first.

The buyer on the other side

A tired person who already tried the blank window. They have 20 minutes after dinner. They will pay \$19 to \$47 to skip inventing the order. They will judge you on chapter one and chapter two, not on your cover.

The offer, named in one sentence

Fill this before you outline

Write this sentence before you outline: I help [specific person] get [named result] in [time] using [named tools], even if [honest objection]. If you cannot fill the brackets, you do not have an offer yet.

Specific person is a job plus a constraint. Named result is a file or a week of work, not a feeling. Time is days or hours. Named tools are what they already have. Honest objection is why they have not done it. Put the sentence at the top of the Doc. Put a shortened version in the checkout title. If you need and to name the result, you have two products. Split them. Sell the one you can finish this week.

Sentences that work

I help one-person landscapers get 10 Google-ready posts in 10 days using ChatGPT and photos they already have, even if they hate writing and only have 20 minutes at night.

I help solo accountants close the month in Claude with a checklist they can rerun, even if their books are messy.

I help realtors write listing descriptions that do not sound like brochures, in one sitting, using the MLS notes they already typed.

I help freelance designers run a client intake in one evening using a form and a follow-up email they can reuse, even if they lose notes in chat.

I help career-switchers ship a job application pack (resume, three bullets, a short note) in one weekend using ChatGPT and their last three roles, even if they freeze on the summary.

Write yours in that shape. One person. One result. One time box. One even-if. Price the result, not the page count.

What they get

A PDF. Eight to 15 chapters, verb-plus-object titles, each ending with a next action. A cover that states the job. Page numbers. Your email on the last page. One template or prompt they can copy. One real example per chapter, names blurred. A 10-day or 14-day plan if the job is a sequence across days. Price \$19 to \$47 on the first file. They get the order, the examples, and the next action. They get a refund line with no speech.

What they do not get

A course. A community. A call. A 200-page book. Five bonuses. Lifetime updates you will not ship. Access to a model. A membership. Your calendar. If they want the sequence installed so the first message is raw material, that is Ship a Claude or ChatGPT skill pack, after this file has a stranger sale. If they want you to do the job, that is Productized AI service. Do not hide a service inside a \$29 PDF.

Packaging

One product, one price, one file. Stripe Payment Link or Stan. Title matches the one-sentence offer. Description is five lines: who, result, time, what is in the file, price. Filename a tired person

can find later: landscaper-10-day-content-playbook.pdf. Cover: the job, the person, the time, the price. First playbooks sell at \$19 to \$47. Raise to \$67 to \$97 when the file has templates, scripts, and a 14-day plan. Do not start at \$297.

One sentence, one product

If you need and to name the result, split. 10 posts is a product. 10 posts and a lead magnet and a Google Business setup is three products. Sell the one you can finish this week. The second file is allowed after a stranger has used the first.

What "done" looks like

Definition

The playbook is done when a stranger can finish chapter one without you in the room. That is the bar. Everything else is decoration.

Done also means: 8 to 15 chapters, each a verb plus an object, each ending with one next action. A cover that states the job. Page numbers. Your email on the last page. A template or prompt they can copy. One real example per chapter, names blurred. Checkout works: you bought it from a second email on a phone and the file opened. Ten personal messages sent. At least one person who is not you owning the file.

The fairness test

Would you sell this to a tired friend who does that job, at \$29, without a speech and without hopping on a call? If you would discount it or offer to walk them through, it is not fair yet. Fair means they can open chapter two at 9 p.m. and do a 20-minute task. Fair means the title matches the file. Fair means a refund in one sentence if it is not useful. Read a chapter to someone who does the job. If they ask so what do I do, rewrite it. If they say I can do that tonight, keep it.

The bar for the file

First chapter is what done looks like, as a file or a week of work. Last chapter is what they do next week. Middle chapters are the work. If a chapter is Why AI matters, delete it. They already bought. Every chapter: one point, one example, one next action. Working files where they can steal them: a box, a back page, a second PDF in the zip. Same words in the title, the checkout, and the first paragraph.

The bar for the checkout and the first week

One product, one price, one file. Title matches the one-sentence offer. Price on the page. Refund line on the page. You have bought it from a second email on a phone. The PDF opens. Filename is human. Ten personal messages sent, at least one person who is not you owning the file, and a note of what they used. That note becomes the next post. If nobody has the file yet, send the next three messages before you rewrite the cover.

Not-done-yet list

- A title with no job in it
- Chapters that are essays with no next action
- No template or prompt they can copy
- Examples from a different trade, or no examples
- Checkout untested
- Price hidden behind DM me
- You have not sent ten asks
- A second product started before a stranger sale
- Hype you would not say at a kitchen table
- You included a call to make it feel premium

If three of those are true, you have a draft. Keep going. The first buyer is not your editor.

Pricing that holds

Ranges

\$19 is a coffee-and-a-tip price. People will try it if the job is named. \$29 is the default first playbook if you include a template or a prompt block. \$47 is fair when there is a 10-day or 14-day plan plus scripts. Put the price on the page. Pick \$29 or \$47 and sit there until a stranger has bought. Stay in the \$19 to \$47 window on the first file. Do not do \$9 to get traction. You will attract collectors, not operators. Do not price by word count.

Why \$29 is the honest default

It is small enough that a tired person will try it to skip a Sunday night. It is large enough that you will answer a support email. If you are ashamed of \$29, you either overbuilt or you do not believe the job is real. Cut the file, or run the job yourself one more time. Round numbers. Price on the button.

When to raise

Raise after a stranger sale and a sentence from them about what they used. Then add the missing template or a 14-day calendar and move to \$67 to \$97. Raise because the file does more, not because you got bored of \$29. Add one working file, not five bonuses. Email the extra page free to people who already paid \$29. Do not start at \$297. Do not add a \$97 with a call on day one unless you mean to run Productized AI service instead.

Refunds in one sentence

If it is not useful, email me and I will refund.

You will refund almost nobody if the first chapter works. Refund with no speech. Then ask what they expected. If two people say the same thing, you fix that chapter. Refunds are cheaper than a reputation for arguing.

What you never charge

Never charge extra for lifetime updates you will not ship. Never charge a setup call inside the \$29. Never charge a second time for v1.1 when a prompt needed one extra line; email it. Never charge \$9. Never hide the price. Never price by page count.

Worked dollars

Dana sells the landscaper playbook at \$29. Day 3 she sends ten texts. Two people she knows buy that night: \$58. A stranger buys on day 11 from a before-and-after post: \$29. Three more in week 3: \$87. One refund from someone who wanted a social media agency in a PDF: minus \$29. She clarifies the title. Month 1 cash is about \$145 after the refund. That is the path. Not a launch. A named job with a working checkout. If she had started at \$297, she would have zero sales. \$29 is the door.

The first 72 hours

Day 1 morning: pick and name

Pick the buyer and the result. Write the one-sentence offer. If you have two ideas, pick the one you can finish without research you have not done. Put the sentence at the top of a Google Doc. Do not survey social media. Do not build a waitlist. One buyer, one result, one sentence. Write it on a sticky note in the buyer's words. If it takes more than one line, it is two products. Split it.

Day 1 afternoon: gather the scars

Collect the raw material you already have: old emails, checklists, prompts that worked, screenshots of a finished result. Dump it under Raw. If the pile is empty, you do not have 72 hours. Run the job this week and capture as you go. Name what went wrong the first time.

Day 1 night: outline like a tired person

Outline 8 to 15 chapters. Each chapter title is a verb plus an object: Write the three hooks. Set the checkout. Send the ten messages. Put a next action under each. First chapter: what done looks like. Last chapter: what they do next week. Middle chapters are the work. If a chapter is Why AI matters, delete it.

Paste this if you want a starting outline, then rewrite every title in your voice:

You are outlining a paid playbook, not a blog. Buyer: [person]. Result they can finish: [result]. Time: [days]. Tools they already have: [tools]. Honest objection: [objection]. Give me 12 chapter

titles as verb + object. Under each, one next action a tired person can do in 20 minutes. No hype. No mindset chapters.

Stop at midnight. You have a sentence, a pile, and an outline. That is a good day.

Day 2: ugly draft, then human

Draft ugly. Use AI for a first pass if you want, then rewrite every paragraph in the voice you would use to a friend at a kitchen table. Cut hype. Keep the steps. Leave holes marked HOLE rather than stopping to research a tool you do not use. Do not format. Do not design a cover. Words first. Keep one example per chapter from real work. End every chapter with one next action. End day 2 with a complete ugly draft, holes marked. Empty chapters are not allowed.

Day 3: rewrite, checkout, ten asks

Rewrite out loud. Add one template and one prompt block. Put the checklist on its own page at the back. If a hole needs a tool you do not use, cut the chapter. Export a clean PDF. Number the chapters. Put your email on the last page.

One product, one price, one file. Stripe Payment Link or Stan. Title matches the one-sentence offer. Buy it yourself from a second email, different browser, on a phone. If the download fails, nothing else matters. Then send ten messages to people who already know you. Not a broadcast. I wrote this for [job]. \$29. If it is useful: [link]. If not, ignore. That is the whole 72 hours.

One buyer, one result, one sentence

8-15 chapters that each end with a next action

Ugly complete draft, then a human rewrite

Working checkout, self-purchase, ten asks

The path, step by step

Step 1. Name the job on a sticky note

If it takes more than one line, it is two products. Split it. Write it in the buyer's words. 10 Google-ready posts for a one-person landscaper is a job. Content system for small businesses is a vibe. Put the sticky note at the top of the Doc.

Step 2. Write the one-sentence offer

I help [specific person] get [named result] in [time] using [named tools], even if [honest objection]. Fill every bracket. This sentence is the cover, the checkout title, and the first line of every message. Do not outline before it exists.

Step 3. Collect the raw material you already have

Old emails, checklists, prompts that worked, screenshots of a finished result. Dump it under Raw. You will mine it, not show it. What went wrong the first time is a chapter. What you do every Sunday night is the spine.

Step 4. Outline for a reader who is tired

First chapter: what done looks like. Last chapter: what they do next week. Middle chapters are the work. 8 to 15 chapters. Each title is a verb plus an object. Each has one next action a tired person can do in 20 minutes. If a chapter is Why AI matters, delete it. If you cannot name the next action, you have an essay.

Step 5. Draft ugly, words first

Do not format yet. Do not design a cover. Leave holes marked HOLE rather than stopping to research a tool you do not use. A complete ugly draft beats a perfect chapter one. If you only have 45 minutes a night, three chapters a night for four nights.

Step 6. Rewrite for voice

Read a page out loud. If you would not say it, delete it. Kitchen table, not conference stage. Short sentences. Named tools. Named times. Keep one example per chapter from real work. Blur names. Keep texture. If a paragraph could run in a motivational clip, cut it.

Step 7. Add the working files

A template, a prompt block, a checklist. Buyers pay more when they can copy, not just read. Put the checklist on its own page at the back. If the working file is in a second download, half your buyers will never open it.

Step 8. Export a clean PDF

Number the chapters. Put your email on the last page. Filename: landscaper-10-day-content-playbook.pdf. Open it on your phone. If the font is tiny or the prompt boxes break, fix the Doc, export again. Cover states the job. No twelve-page brand story.

Step 9. Build the checkout

Stripe Payment Link or Stan. Title matches the one-sentence offer. Description is five lines: who, result, time, what is in the file, price. Price on the page. Refund line on the page. One product. If the page is a menu of six ideas, cut it back to this playbook.

Step 10. Test-buy from a second email

Different browser, different email, on a phone. Confirm the file arrives and opens. If the download never arrives, fix that before you send a single ask. This step feels small. It is the whole business on day three.

Step 11. Write ten names, then send ten personal messages

Not a broadcast. People who already know you or do the job. I wrote this for [job]. \$29. If it is useful: [link]. If not, ignore. First sale is allowed to be someone you know. Which chapter did you actually do is better than Did you like it.

Step 12. After the first stranger sale, ask what they used

That sentence becomes your next ten posts. Teach one chapter, three times. Soft link. Do not write book two. Fix the first trip-up: a broken download, a prompt that needed one extra line, a chapter that assumed they had a desktop.

Step 13. Fix, version, email

If two buyers trip on the same chapter, rewrite that chapter this week. Bump a line on the last page: v1.1, date. Email the people who already bought. Do not add five bonuses. Do not redesign the cover instead of fixing the chapter.

Step 14. Raise only when the file does more

After a stranger sale and a used-chapter sentence, add the missing template or a 14-day calendar. Move new sales to \$47 or \$67. Email the extra free to people who already paid. Raise because the file does more, not because you got bored of \$29.

Step 15. Only then consider a second product

A prompt stack if they say can I just have the prompt. A skill pack if they say I want this inside Claude. A template if they want the checklist as a filled file. Not before a stranger has bought and used a chapter.

Step 16. Stop

Do not add a membership so you can delay shipping. Do not open a course platform. Do not start book two because week 3 felt quiet. Quiet is usually ten more asks and a clearer title, not a second file. Ship at the bar. Fix after the first ten asks.

A worked example

Dana, one-person landscaping companies, \$29

Dana already writes a few Google posts for her own company when she remembers. She is not a content person. She is a person who got tired of a blank chat window every Sunday night. She writes a playbook called 10 days of Google-ready posts for a one-person landscaping company. Price: \$29. File: one PDF plus a one-page caption template.

Her one sentence: I help one-person landscapers get 10 Google-ready posts in 10 days using ChatGPT and job photos they already have, even if they hate writing and only have 20 minutes

at night.

Calendar: days 1 to 21

Day 1: sticky note, dump old captions and photos into Raw, 12 chapter titles as verb plus object.
 Days 2 to 4: ugly draft. She uses a model for first passes, then rewrites at the kitchen table after dinner. She will not teach a scheduler she does not use. Day 5: rewrite out loud. She cuts a chapter on personal branding. Day 6: caption template, batch prompt, checklist. Export PDF.
 Filename: landscaper-10-day-content-playbook.pdf.

Day 7: Stripe Payment Link titled the same as the sentence. She buys it from her other Gmail on her phone. The PDF opens. Night: ten texts to owners she had swapped trailers with, a local Facebook group she already helps, her cousin who runs a lawn crew, and old clients who ask how she does the posting.

What she put in the file

Twelve chapters, each with a next action:

What done looks like — 10 posts scheduled, each with a photo, a caption, and a phone-number line.

Pull 10 photos off your phone from jobs you finished this month.

Pick three post types only: before/after, this-week offer, FAQ.

Write the three hooks you will reuse.

Turn one finished job into a before/after caption.

Write the this-week offer without sounding cheap.

Write the FAQ post that answers why does this cost that.

Paste the batch prompt and generate the other seven captions.

Put the phone number in the last line of every post. Same line, every time.

The 10-day calendar (which post, which photo, which morning).

What to do when nobody comments (you still posted; call three old clients).

What you do next week (repeat the same three types; do not invent a fourth).

She included one prompt they paste with a photo description and a price, and a caption template with blanks. She did not include a module on personal branding.

How she sold the first copies, with dollars

The text: I put a short playbook up for one-person landscaping companies that need 10 Google posts. One file, \$29, instant download. If that is useful: [link]. If not, no need to reply.

Two people she knew bought on day 7. \$58. She asked which chapter they actually did. One said chapter 5, the before/after caption. Day 11: she posted one before/after from her own yard with the last line I wrote the 10-day sequence I use. \$29. Link in bio. A stranger bought. \$29. First stranger sale. Chapter 5 became her next five posts. Two more sales in week 3: \$58. One person asked for a refund because they wanted her to post for them. She refunded \$29 with no speech. She added one line to the listing: this is a file, not a social media manager.

Week 4: she fixed the batch prompt with one extra line: do not invent a discount I did not type. She emailed v1.1 to the five people who had bought. She did not write book two. Month 1: six sales at \$29, one refund. Net \$145. Not a launch. A named job.

The mistake and the recovery

On day 9 a buyer said chapter 8 assumed they had a desktop. They work from a phone in the truck. Dana rewrote the paste steps for mobile, exported, emailed both buyers. That is v1.1. The chapter got usable in a truck. She did not add a bonus video.

Shipped artifact: a 22-page PDF, 12 chapters, caption template, batch prompt, checklist. She asks every buyer which chapter they used. Chapter 5 stays the public example. She still has not written the irrigation-estimate playbook. Nobody asked for it.

Copy you can actually send

Swap the job. Keep the constraints. Do not add hype. Paste these as they are. Fill the brackets. Send.

DM (text or email)

I put a short playbook live for [job]. One file, \$29, instant download. If that is useful: [link]. If not, no need to reply.

Post

Blank chat is expensive. I wrote the sequence I actually use for [result]. \$29. Link in bio.

This is 10 days of posts for a one-person [trade], written so you can do it after dinner. \$29. Not another AI dump.

Listing title and body

Title: [Job] in [time] — a playbook for [person], not another AI dump.

Body, five lines:

Who it is for: [person].

What they finish: [result] in [time].

What they get: a PDF with [N] chapters, a paste-ready prompt, and a checklist.

What they need: [named tools], no extra subscriptions.

Price: \$29. Instant download. Email me if it is not useful and I will refund.

Email to people who already know you

Subject: the [job] sequence, written down

I got tired of explaining this in pieces, so I wrote a short playbook. It is the order I actually use for [result], including the prompt and the checklist. \$29, one file.

If you want it: [link].

If you do not, delete this. I will not follow up.

Email after a stranger sale (ask what they used)

Subject: which chapter did you actually do?

If you bought the [job] playbook, reply with the chapter you used. I will fix anything that tripped you. If you have not started, chapter two is a 20-minute task. That is the whole point.

Reply: I can just ask ChatGPT

You can. The playbook is the order, the examples from [job], and the next action at the end of each chapter so you do not stall at a blank window. If you already have a sequence you like, you do not need this. If you keep starting over, \$29 is cheaper than another Sunday night.

Reply: I do not have time to read a book

It is [N] short chapters. Chapter one is what done looks like. Chapter two is a 20-minute task. If you cannot do chapter two this week, wait.

Reply: Can you just do this for me?

This file is the sequence. I do not include a call at \$29. If you want someone to do the job, that is a service at a different number. I will refund you if you bought thinking I would post for you.

Refund

You asked for a refund. Here it is, no speech. If a chapter tripped you, tell me the number. I will fix the file for everyone else. The refund is already processing.

Week-by-week if you have a job

Assume evenings. This is four weeks to a used playbook, not a content brand. No public launch in week 1.

Week 1: outline and ugly draft

Monday: sticky note, one sentence, ten names written down. Do not send yet. Tuesday: outline 8 to 15 chapters with next actions. First chapter is done. Last chapter is next week. Wednesday through Saturday: ugly draft. Three chapters a night if you have 45 minutes. Holes marked HOLE. Do not open Canva. Sunday: complete ugly draft in one file. Do not list 9 chapters. Keep going.

Week 2: rewrite, templates, checkout, ten asks

Monday: rewrite out loud. Cut hype. Keep one example per chapter. Tuesday: add one template and one prompt block. Checklist on the last page. Export PDF. Open it on your phone.

Wednesday: Stripe or Stan. Title matches the sentence. Price \$29. Test-buy from a second email on your phone. Thursday and Friday: ten personal messages. First sale is allowed to be someone you know. Ask which chapter they did. Saturday: one public post with a photo of the finished job, not the cover, if you are public. If you are not, send three more personal messages. Sunday: ten asks should be done. Do not redesign the cover instead. Do not add a second product this week.

Week 3: teach one chapter, three times

Three posts or emails that teach one chapter. Soft link. If you are not public, send three more personal messages instead of posts. Ask every buyer which chapter they used. Fix whatever they tripped on the same week. If refunds say I thought you would post for me, the listing is the bug. Do not write book two. Do not raise the price yet.

Week 4: fix, do not expand

Fix whatever the first buyers tripped on. A broken download. A prompt that needed one extra line. A chapter that assumed they had a desktop. Email v1.1 to people who bought. If nobody bought, send ten new asks, then look at the title. The title is usually the problem, not the prose. A 14-day calendar only if they ask. \$29 stays, or \$47 for the file-plus-calendar. Email the extra page free to people who already paid \$29. Plan a second playbook only after a stranger has used a chapter.

Quality bar

Voice

Kitchen table, not conference stage. Short sentences. Named tools. Named times. If a paragraph could run in a motivational clip, cut it. Read the first page to someone who does the job. I could do that means you passed.

Structure

Every chapter: one point, one example, one next action. Put the working files where they can steal them. Number the chapters. Use the same words in the title, the checkout, and the first paragraph. First chapter is what done looks like. Last chapter is next week. No mindset chapter.

Proof inside the file

One real example per chapter beats five generic screenshots. Blur names. Keep the texture: the actual price, the actual photo description, the bad first draft and the good second. Do not invent a dramatic client story.

Test 1: the next-action test

Open the PDF at a random chapter. If you cannot find one next action a tired person can do in 20 minutes, that chapter fails. Fix it before you advertise.

Test 2: the kitchen-table test

Read a page out loud. If you would not say it to a friend after dinner, delete it. Hype fails this test. Named tools and named times pass.

Test 3: the stranger-chapter-one test

Hand chapter one to someone who does the job. Do not hover. If they can finish it without you in the room, you passed. If they ask so what do I do, rewrite it. This is the bar this path names.

Test 4: the phone test

Open the PDF on a phone. Font readable. Prompt boxes intact. If chapter two assumes a desktop they do not have, rewrite the steps for mobile. Dana's buyer in the truck is the test.

Test 5: the claims test

No promise that the playbook replaces a license, an accountant, a lawyer, or a clinician. No guaranteed leads. Operational sequence only. Refund the person who bought a fantasy.

Below the bar

An essay with no next action. A ChatGPT paste with a cover. A title with no job. A call hidden in \$29. Five bonuses and no core file. If a tired person cannot start chapter two tonight, it is below the bar.

Metrics that matter (and vanity numbers to ignore)

Count these

Checkout works: self-purchase from a second email, file opens on a phone.

Messages sent: ten in the first 72 hours, then ten more if nobody bought.

Sales from people who are not you. One stranger sale is the real start.

Which chapter did you use answers. That sentence is your next post.

Refunds. If you get more than one in the first ten sales, chapter one is unclear or the title oversold.

Trip-ups fixed and v1.1 emailed.

Week 1

Count: sentence exists, chapters outlined, ugly draft complete. If the draft is not complete, you do not have a product yet. Do not count cover drafts.

Day 30

Count personal messages (target 10 in week 2, then a few each week). Sales. Stranger sales as a subset. Chapter-used-first. Refunds with a one-word reason. A healthy day-30: complete file, working checkout, 10+ asks, 1+ stranger sale, 0–1 refunds.

Day 90

Count v1.1 shipped (yes/no). Second product (should still be no, unless a stranger asked for the next job). Cash in the \$19 to \$47 window, totaled. If you have \$0 at day 90, the failure is usually title, unsent asks, or chapter one that does not survive a tired Sunday. It is rarely the market.

Ignore these

Landing page visits with no checkout. Follower counts. Cover polish. Word count. A playbook with 12 visitors and three sales is healthy. A playbook with 2,000 visitors and zero sales has a broken offer or a broken title.

A simple weekly log

One line a week: date, messages sent, sales, stranger sales, refunds, one buyer sentence, version number. If the buyer sentence is always empty, you are not asking. Ask.

Objections you will hear

I can get this free from ChatGPT

Plain answer: they can get a draft. They cannot get your order of operations, your examples from this job, and a next action at the end of every chapter. If they already have that sequence, they should not buy. If they keep staring at a blank window, \$29 is the sequence.

I do not know if I am qualified to write this

If you have done the job three times and can name what went wrong the first time, you are qualified for a \$19 to \$47 playbook. You are not applying to teach a university course. You are handing a tired person the notes you wish you had.

Nobody will pay for a PDF

People pay for PDFs every day when the job is named and the checkout is simple. Name the person, the result, and the time. Put the price on the page. Ask ten people.

I need a course platform / a big list / a funnel

You need Google Docs, a Payment Link, and ten messages. A course platform is how people delay chapter one. After a stranger has bought, you can put the same file on a nicer page. Not before.

What if they want a refund

You refund them. One sentence. Then you ask what they expected. If two people say the same thing, you fix that chapter. Refunds are cheaper than a reputation for arguing.

I do not have time to write a book

You are not writing a book. You are writing 8 to 15 short chapters that each end with a 20-minute task. Two evenings to outline. Four to draft. Two to rewrite and ship.

Can I just charge \$97 on day one if I include a call

You can, but you just built a service with a PDF attached. Keep the file at \$19 to \$47 and do not include your calendar. If you want to get paid this week with your time, use Productized AI service and come back.

My niche is too small

Small is the point. How to use ChatGPT sits in a pile of free posts. A 10-day content system for a one-person landscaping company is a product. Ten people who do the job are enough to start.

What if someone copies it

They might. They will not have your examples, your scars, or your next actions from this job. Ship anyway.

I should wait until it feels ready

Ready is a stranger finishing chapter one without you in the room. Ship at that bar. Fix after the first ten asks. Waiting is how the everything-AI book gets to page 80 with no checkout.

How this feeds other paths

Upstream: what you need before this

You need a result you have finished more than twice, including for yourself. If you have never finished the job, take a productized service job or a local-business week first. Capture as you go. Then write.

Products that grow out of the same notes

The playbook is often the first product because it is the sequence in your head, written down. The same notes become Niche prompt stacks (the prompt blocks, sold on their own), Ship a Claude or ChatGPT skill pack (the instructions, installed so they never paste again), and AI templates and SOPs (the checklist as a filled file). Do not split them until the playbook has a stranger sale. If they say can I just have the prompt, that is a prompt stack. If they say I want this inside Claude, that is a skill pack.

Distribution that uses the same chapters

AI-assisted short-form: each chapter is a 20-second video. Teach chapter 5. Sell the playbook. A weekly AI letter: one chapter taught, one link to the file. Your front door: a diagnostic that tells them which chapter they need, then the playbook.

Services and later products

Local businesses + AI and Productized AI service are how you get paid while the playbook is still a draft — do the job once for a nearby owner, then write what you did. A small AI membership comes after, when you have updates worth a monthly. Do not open all of those doors this month. Finish the playbook.

What not to feed yet

A membership. A 200-page book. Thirty days, one playbook, one job in the title. After a stranger uses a chapter, the next path is the one they asked for.

Mistakes that kill this path

I. Writing for entrepreneurs

That is not a buyer. Recovery this week: pick a job. Put that word in the title. Share in that room.

2. Writing 80 pages of theory

Recovery this week: cut to 8 to 15 chapters that each end with a next action. Ship the job.

3. Shipping a ChatGPT paste

Recovery this week: rewrite out loud. Add one real example per chapter. Add a next action. If you cannot, do not list it.

4. Hiding the price

Recovery this week: put \$29 on the page. Remove DM me. Send ten asks with the number in the message.

5. Launching with five bonuses and no core file

Recovery this week: ship the one file. Archive the bonuses.

6. Waiting until it feels ready

Recovery this week: apply the chapter-one test tonight. If a stranger can finish it, export and send ten asks. If they cannot, rewrite chapter one.

7. Naming it The AI Playbook with no job in the title

Recovery this week: rename. 10 days of Google-ready posts for a one-person landscaping company. Same file, new title, same \$29.

8. Building a course platform before a PDF

Recovery this week: export the PDF. Payment Link. Self-buy. Ten asks.

9. Adding a membership so you can delay shipping

Recovery this week: close the membership draft. Finish chapter 12. Ship v1.0.

10. Redesigning the cover four times

Recovery this week: a cover that states the job is enough. Send the next three messages before you touch the cover again.

11. Putting your whole catalog in the listing

Recovery this week: one product, one price, one file. Move the other ideas to a note.

12. Using someone else's examples from a different trade

Recovery this week: replace every example with one from the job you actually do. Blur names. Keep texture. If you have no examples, run the job this week and capture.

13. Assuming a desktop they do not have

Recovery this week: open your own PDF on a phone. Rewrite any step that needs a sidebar they will never open. Email v1.1.

14. Starting book two before a stranger sale

Recovery this week: close the other draft. Ask the people who already bought which chapter they used. Fix that one. Send ten new asks.

The bar, again

The playbook is ready when a stranger can finish chapter one without you in the room. Ship at that bar. Fix after the first ten asks. Do not invent a dramatic client story. Do not scrape someone else's captions.

Tools and how you actually use them

Writing

Google Docs or Word. One document. The model you already use is enough for the ugly draft. The rewrite is you. Export PDF. Open it on your phone. If the font is tiny or the prompt boxes

break, fix the Doc, export again. Filename a human can find. Reply-to on the last page. One Doc from sticky note to export.

Checkout

Stripe Payment Link or Stan Store. One product. Title equals the offer sentence, shortened. After payment, the file. You do not need a full site. Put the refund line on the page. Put the price on the page.

The second email

Create it before you launch. Buy your own product. If the download never arrives, fix that before you send a single ask. This step feels small. It is the whole business on day three.

What not to buy

A course platform. A funnel builder. Ads. A designer for a cover that hides the job. A membership tool. You are selling a \$29 PDF.

The \$0 path

Docs or Word you already have. A model free tier is enough to draft if you already use one.

Checkout: Stripe Payment Link (cost per sale) or Stan if you already have an account. Export PDF from Docs. Share with ten people you already know.

Setup order

Open a Doc. Title with the job. Paste the one-sentence offer at the top. Outline 8 to 15 chapters.

Draft. Rewrite. Add the template and the prompt. Export PDF. Create the payment link with that PDF. Buy it from the second email on a phone. Then send ten asks. Do not compare six checkouts.

Ship checklist

Before anyone else sees it

One-sentence offer with all five brackets filled

Sticky note in the buyer's words, one line

8-15 chapters, verb + object titles, each ending with a next action

First chapter is what done looks like; last chapter is next week

No Why AI matters chapter

One real example per chapter, names blurred, texture kept

One prompt they can paste

One template they can copy

One checklist on its own back page

Rewrite read out loud; hype cut

Kitchen-table test passed on page one

PDF opens on a phone; font readable; prompt boxes intact

Email on the last page

Filename a tired person can find later

Cover states the job, the person, and the time

Before you send the ten asks

Checkout title matches the offer

Price on the page (\$19-\$47)

Refund line on the page

Five-line listing: who, result, time, what is in the file, price

Bought from a second email, different browser

File arrived and opened on a phone

Ten names written down

Message copied, link tested

No second product, no bonus pile

No call included in the \$29

After the first sale

Ask: which chapter did you actually use?

Fix the first trip-up the same week

Email v1.1 to people who bought

Teach one used chapter, three times

Do not start book two

Log: date, messages, sales, stranger sales, refunds, buyer sentence

Raise only when the file does more

FAQ

Do I need a big audience?

No. You need ten people who already know you or do the job, a working checkout, and a file that survives chapter one without you.

How long should it be?

Long enough that a tired person can finish the job, short enough that they will start tonight. Most first playbooks are 12-25 pages including the checklist. If you are at 80 pages, you wrote essays. Cut or split.

Can I use AI to write the whole thing?

You can use it to draft. You cannot ship the draft. The buyer is paying for your order, your examples, and your next actions. A pasted ChatGPT article with a cover is the fastest way to a refund.

What if I do not have screenshots or old emails?

Run the job once this week for yourself or for one person. Capture as you go. If you cannot run the job this week, this is not your path yet. Do a service job, then write.

Stripe or Stan?

Either. Stripe Payment Link is enough if you are comfortable with a raw link. Stan is enough if you want the page and the file in one place. Pick one tonight. Do not compare six platforms.

Should I put it on Etsy or Gumroad too?

Not in week one. Sell where you can send a link to ten people. After a stranger sale, you can add a marketplace if the title matches how people search.

What do I do after ten asks and zero sales?

Ask one of the ten: Was the job wrong, the price wrong, or the timing wrong? Then look at the title. Most first misses are a vague title. Rewrite the sentence. Send ten new asks. Do not rewrite the whole PDF yet.

Can I charge \$97 on day one if I include a call?

You can, but you just built a service with a PDF attached. If you want the playbook path, keep the file at \$19 to \$47 and do not include your calendar. If you want to get paid this week with your time, use Productized AI service and come back.

When do I write the second playbook?

After a stranger has bought the first, told you what they used, and you have fixed the trip-ups. Then only if they ask for the next job.

Is a playbook the same as a prompt pack?

No. A playbook is the sequence, with prompts inside it. A prompt stack is the prompts, with a one-page SOP for which to use when. Dana wrote a playbook because landscapers needed the 10-day order, not 200 clever lines.

How many chapters do I need?

Eight to 15. Under eight, you probably hid the work. Over 15, you probably wrote essays. If a chapter has no next action, it does not count.

What if I hate my writing voice?

Read it out loud. Cut anything you would not say after dinner. Short sentences. Named tools. You are handing notes to a tired friend.

Do I need a cover designer?

No. A cover that states the job is enough. Redesigning the cover four times is a listed mistake.

What if a buyer wants me to customize it for their company?

That is a service. Send a price or send the cheaper file. Do not hop on a \$29 call that becomes the job.

When do I raise from \$29 to \$47?

After a stranger sale, a used-chapter sentence, and one extra working file they asked for. Raise new sales. Email the extra free to people who already paid.